

Blink Camera Archiver

Automatic Video Backup Solution

Protect your security footage from tampering or deletion

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Table of Contents

- 1. Overview
- 2. Features
- 3. Requirements
- 4. Installation
- 5. Configuration
- 6. Usage
- 7. Running as a Service
- 8. Code Structure
- 9. Troubleshooting
- 10. Security Notes
- 11. API Information
- 12. License and Credits

1. Overview

The Blink Camera Archiver is a Python-based tool that automatically downloads and archives video clips from your Blink home security cameras. It runs at regular intervals and saves all new videos to local storage, protecting them from tampering or cloud deletion.

This tool is designed for users who want complete control over their security footage and want to ensure that videos are permanently backed up before they can be altered or removed from the cloud.

2. Features

- Automatic video archiving from all Blink cameras
- Tracks downloaded videos to avoid duplicates
- Organizes videos by camera name and date
- Respects Blink's API rate limits (60-second minimum)
- Supports 2FA authentication
- Configurable check intervals
- Can run as one-time check or continuous daemon
- Comprehensive logging and error handling
- Lightweight and efficient
- Cross-platform (Linux, macOS, Windows)
- Easy setup with automated scripts
- Can be configured as a system service

3. Requirements

System Requirements

- Python 3.8 or later
- Internet connection
- Blink account with active cameras
- Sufficient storage space for video archives

Python Dependencies

- blinkpy >= 0.24.0 (Blink API library)
- aiohttp >= 3.9.0 (Async HTTP client)
- aiofiles >= 23.0.0 (Async file operations)
- python-dateutil >= 2.8.0 (Date parsing)

4. Installation

Quick Setup (Recommended)

Run the automated setup script:

```
chmod +x setup.sh  
./setup.sh
```

This will:

- Create a Python virtual environment
- Install all required dependencies
- Create a config.json file from the example

Manual Installation

If you prefer manual setup:

```
# Create virtual environment python3 -m venv venv source venv/bin/activate #  
Install dependencies pip install -r requirements.txt # Copy and edit config  
cp config.example.json config.json
```

5. Configuration

Edit config.json with your Blink account credentials and preferences:

```
{ "username": "your_blink_email@example.com", "password":  
  "your_blink_password", "download_path": "./videos", "check_interval_seconds":  
  300, "archive_db_path": "./archive_db.json", "log_file":  
  "./blink_archiver.log", "log_level": "INFO" }
```

Configuration Parameters

- **username:** Your Blink account email address
- **password:** Your Blink account password
- **download_path:** Directory where videos will be saved
- **check_interval_seconds:** How often to check for new videos (min 60)
- **archive_db_path:** Path to database tracking downloaded videos
- **log_file:** Path to the log file
- **log_level:** Logging verbosity (DEBUG, INFO, WARNING, ERROR)

Two-Factor Authentication

If your Blink account has 2FA enabled, you will be prompted to enter the verification code when running the archiver. The code will be sent to your registered email or phone.

6. Usage

Basic Usage

Command syntax:

```
python3 blink_archiver.py [OPTIONS]
```

Command-Line Options

- **--config PATH:** Path to configuration file (default: config.json)
- **--once:** Run once and exit (default: run continuously)
- **--since-days N:** Download videos from the last N days (default: 1)

Usage Examples

Run once to test:

```
./run.sh --once
```

Run continuously (default mode):

```
./run.sh
```

Run in background:

```
nohup ./run.sh &
```

Download videos from the last 7 days:

```
python3 blink_archiver.py --once --since-days 7
```

7. Running as a Service

systemd (Linux)

Create a systemd service file:

```
sudo nano /etc/systemd/system/blink-archiver.service

[Unit] Description=Blink Camera Archiver After=network.target [Service]
Type=simple User=youruser WorkingDirectory=/path/to/inablink
ExecStart=/path/to/inablink/run.sh Restart=always RestartSec=10 [Install]
WantedBy=multi-user.target
```

Enable and start the service:

```
sudo systemctl enable blink-archiver sudo systemctl start blink-archiver sudo
systemctl status blink-archiver
```

cron (Linux/macOS)

For periodic checks, add to crontab:

```
crontab -e
```

Add this line (runs every 5 minutes):

```
*/5 * * * * /path/to/inablink/run.sh --once >> /path/to/cron.log 2>&1
```

8. Code Structure

Main Components

BlinkArchiver Class:

- **__init__**: Initialize archiver with configuration
- **authenticate**: Handle Blink authentication and 2FA
- **get_all_cameras**: Retrieve list of all cameras
- **download_new_videos**: Download videos not yet archived
- **run_once**: Execute single archival cycle
- **run_continuous**: Run continuous monitoring loop
- **cleanup**: Clean up resources on shutdown

Directory Structure

```
inablink/ ■■■ blink_archiver.py # Main script ■■■ config.json # Your
configuration ■■■ archive_db.json # Downloaded videos database ■■■
blink_archiver.log # Log file ■■■ videos/ # Downloaded videos ■ ■■■
Front_Door/ # Camera folders ■ ■■■ Backyard/ ■■■ requirements.txt ■■■
setup.sh ■■■ README.md
```

9. Troubleshooting

Authentication Fails

- Verify username and password in config.json
- Check if 2FA code was entered correctly
- Ensure account is not locked
- Try logging in through Blink app first
- Check internet connection

No Videos Downloaded

- Verify cameras have recorded videos
- Check videos exist in the Blink mobile app
- Try using --since-days flag with larger value
- Check log file for specific errors
- Ensure cameras are online and armed

Rate Limit Errors

- Ensure check_interval_seconds is at least 60
- Increase interval to 300 seconds (5 minutes) or more
- The Blink API recommends intervals of 60+ seconds
- Avoid running multiple instances simultaneously

10. Security Notes

- Keep config.json secure - it contains your credentials
- Never commit config.json to version control
- The .gitignore file prevents committing sensitive files
- Consider using environment variables for credentials
- Regularly backup your archived videos to external storage
- Use strong, unique passwords for your Blink account
- Enable 2FA on your Blink account for extra security
- Set appropriate file permissions on config.json (chmod 600)
- Store archived videos on encrypted drives if possible
- Monitor log files for suspicious authentication attempts

11. API Information

Blink API Library

This tool uses the blinkpy library (github.com/fronzbot/blinkpy), which is actively maintained and provides a Python interface to the Blink camera API.

Rate Limiting

Important API guidelines:

- Minimum 60-second interval between API calls
- Default check interval is 300 seconds (5 minutes)
- Tool automatically enforces minimum intervals
- Excessive API calls can overwhelm Blink servers
- Tool implements delays between operations

How It Works

1. Authenticates with Blink servers using credentials
2. Retrieves list of all cameras on your account
3. For each camera, fetches recent video clips
4. Checks local database to avoid re-downloading
5. Downloads new videos and saves organized by camera
6. Updates tracking database with downloaded clip IDs
7. Waits for configured interval and repeats

12. License and Credits

License

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Credits

Built using the blinkpy library by fronzbot for Blink API access.

GitHub: <https://github.com/fronzbot/blinkpy>

Disclaimer

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Contributing

Issues and pull requests are welcome at the project repository. Please follow standard GitHub contribution guidelines.

Appendix: Repository Information

Git Repository

Repository: stimutak/inablink

Branch: claude/blink-camera-archiver-011CUUuc2imcDEExf48jUcWX

Files Committed

- blink_archiver.py (main script)
- requirements.txt
- config.example.json
- setup.sh
- run.sh
- .gitignore
- LICENSE
- README.md

Pull Request

Create pull request at: <https://github.com/stimutak/inablink/pull/new/claude/blink-camera-archiver-011CUUuc2imcDEExf48jUcWX>